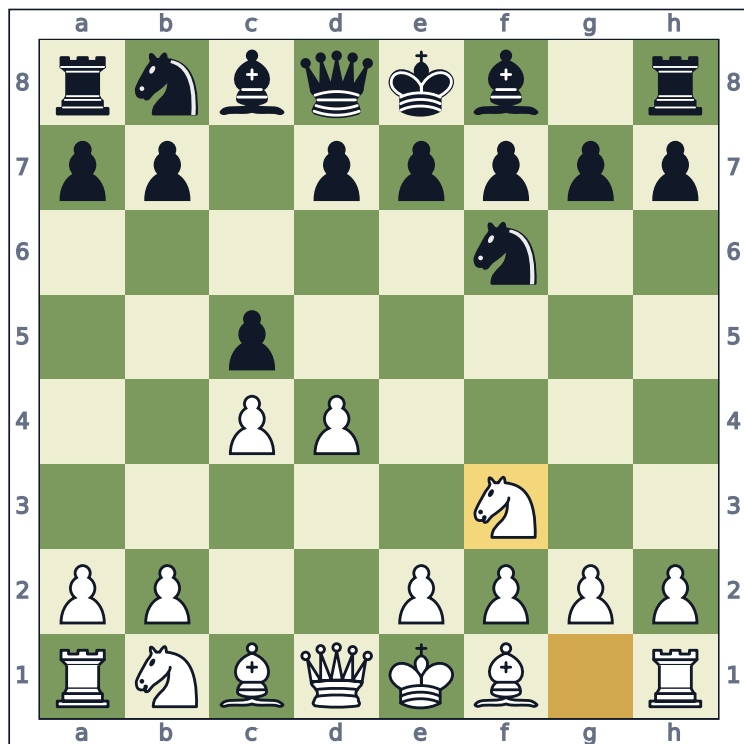


ENGLISH OPENING

English Opening

ECO A31 | 1 named line in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.27 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Strategic and flexible: small move-order choices decide which pawn structure appears.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

A31 covers English Opening. White attacks the center with c4 and often creates a reversed Sicilian, Hedgehog, or queenside pressure game. The diagram uses the featured line English Opening: Symmetrical Variation, Anti-Benoni Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. c4 Nf6 2. d4 c5 3. Nf3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Control d5, develop the g2 bishop when appropriate, and choose between d4, e4, or a queenside expansion.

BLACK'S GOALS

Build a stable central claim with ...e5 or ...d5, challenge c4, and watch White's long diagonal and queenside space.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White's main breaks are d4, b4, and sometimes f4; Black commonly seeks ...d5, ...b5, or ...f5.

PIECE MAP

The g2 bishop, c-file rooks, and knights on c3/f3 usually coordinate around d5. Black needs active central counterplay. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

A slow maneuver can be punished if the opponent achieves a clean central break first. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Excellent for players who like strategic maneuvering and transpositions, but it rewards understanding more than rote memorization.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A31 line

This section preserves all 1 names and defining routes assigned to A31 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 **English Opening: Symmetrical Variation, Anti-Benoni Variation**
1. c4 Nf6 2. d4 c5 3. Nf3